Worksheet 1: Unknown Digestive Juices X and Y

Name: _____ Class: _____ No.: _____

Context: lipids need digestion before absorption. What happens after adding digestive juice X or Y?



Part 1 | Main investigation design: compare X and Y

Add 2 mL X or 2 mL Y to identical oil–water mixtures. Shake in the same way at 37°C; compare after one hour.

1. Identify the variables: choose all appropriate factors in each row.

IV(the factor changed on purpose)；DV(the result you measure or observe)；CV(the factors kept the same)

Independent variable	Total volume of oil and water ／ Reaction temperature ／ Reaction time ／ Total volume of liquid added ／ Method of shaking ／ Appearance of the mixture ／ Combination of digestive juices
Dependent variable	Total volume of oil and water ／ Reaction temperature ／ Reaction time ／ Total volume of liquid added ／ Method of shaking ／ Appearance of the mixture ／ Combination of digestive juices
Controlled variables	Total volume of oil and water ／ Reaction temperature ／ Reaction time ／ Total volume of liquid added ／ Method of shaking ／ Appearance of the mixture ／ Combination of digestive juices

2. Select the assumptions for a fair comparison (choose all that apply)

(An assumption is a condition we have not proved but take as true, to help make the experiment results valid.)

□ Observe all setups after the same reaction time.

□ Use the same starting amounts of oil and water and the same total volume of added liquid in each setup.

□ Use the same method of shaking for every setup.

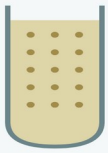
□ The X setup may receive more total liquid than the Y setup.

Part 1 | Main results and analysis

Both model results show one hour after adding the juice and shaking.

Set X

Add 2 mL X



Cloudy emulsion

Set Y

Add 2 mL Y



Thinner oil layer; two layers remain

3. Appearance of X after one hour

☐ a cloudy emulsion

☐ The oil layer disappears

4. Appearance of Y after one hour

☐ Thinner oil layer, with two layers remaining

☐ No obvious change in the oil layer

Next: how might the emulsion formed by X affect the later action of Y?

Extension 1 uses two fresh tubes. Add X or an equal volume of water and shake, then add the same amount of Y. Both have the same pretreatment time.

Part 2 | Extension 1: how does X help Y?

The following model results show one hour after adding Y.

X first, then Y

1 mL X → 1 mL Y



Less cloudy
No obvious oil layer

Water first, then Y

1 mL water → 1 mL Y



Thinner oil layer
Two layers remain

5. How does X help Y act?

X disperses large oil droplets into smaller droplets. The total surface area of the same amount of lipid:

☐ increase

☐ decrease

Part 2 | Extension 1: further analysis

6. What does appearance tell us?

□ Appearance provides clues about the effects of digestive juices, but alone cannot prove that glycerol and fatty acids have formed.

□ Disappearance of the oil layer completely proves that lipids have broken down into glycerol and fatty acids.

Part 3 | Extension 2: effects of boiling

Use unboiled X followed by Y from Extension 1 as the baseline. Boil one juice, cool to 37°C, then add 1 mL each of X and Y in the same order; observe after one hour.

Boiled X + unboiled Y

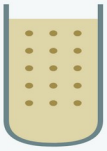
Use after cooling



Less cloudy; no oil layer

Unboiled X + boiled Y

Use after cooling



Cloudy emulsion

7. Which juice loses its action after boiling?

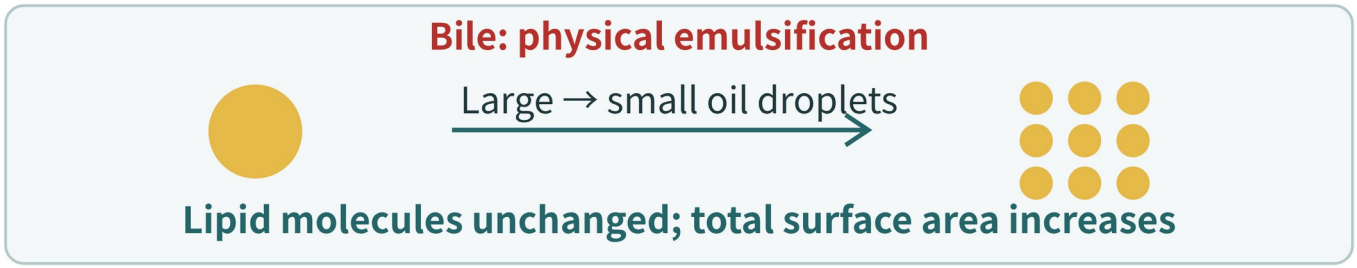
□ Digestive juice X

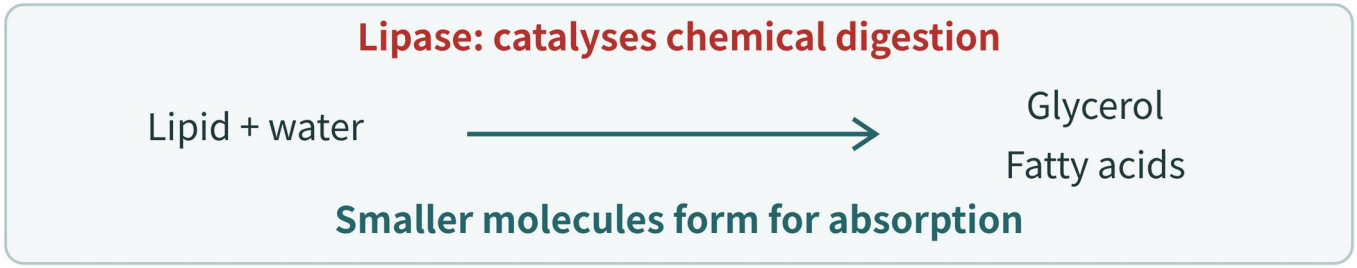
□ Digestive juice Y

Learning points | Topic notes

X is **bile**, containing no digestive enzymes. It **physically emulsifies** large oil droplets into smaller droplets without changing lipid molecules. The greater **total surface area** helps **lipase** contact lipids.

Y is **pancreatic juice** containing **lipase**. **Lipase** catalyses **chemical digestion**, forming **glycerol** and **fatty acids** in this course's simplified complete-hydrolysis model. **Lipase** is a **protein**: boiling **denatures** it and stops its action, which cooling does not restore. **Bile** retains emulsifying action after boiling in this model.





Integrated explanation

8. Using the experimental results and topic notes, explain how bile and lipase in pancreatic juice work together to help digest lipids, and how boiling affects their actions.